MCP PRODUCTION · SPEC REVISION 2026-07-28

Reading one request

The reference sheet from lesson 1.2: what each header and body field means under revision 2026-07-28, and the check that keeps the two from contradicting each other.

FIELD	MEANING	CHECK
HTTP endpoint	Server entry point	Correct path and destination
`method`	Protocol operation	Mirrors `Mcp-Method`
`params.name`	Addressed tool or prompt	Mirrors decoded `Mcp-Name` where required
`params.uri`	Addressed resource	Mirrors decoded `Mcp-Name` on `resources/read`
`params.arguments`	Tool input	Validate against the tool contract
`id`	Request correlation	Match the response; not an idempotency key
`_meta.io.modelcontextprotocol/protocolVersion`	Requested contract	Mirrors `MCP-Protocol-Version`
`_meta.io.modelcontextprotocol/clientInfo`	Optional client self-description	Not authenticated identity
`_meta.io.modelcontextprotocol/clientCapabilities`	Declared supported behavior	Not authorization

The `_meta` object belongs under `params`. `Mcp-Name` is required for `tools/call`, `prompts/get`, and `resources/read`, not for every method. Header names are case-insensitive; method/name values are case-sensitive. The prescribed name encoding is `=?base64?{UTF-8 bytes encoded as Base64}?=`. Decode before comparing; malformed encodings are not empty names.

Source: HTTP binding, checked 2026-09-09.

> **Where this goes next.** Lab 1 builds a server that rejects a request whose headers disagree with its body, and runs the same fixtures against a TypeScript and a Python implementation. The course: runsclean.com/courses/mcp-production/